

Q1 Proposal Rubric

Weight of assessment in final grade: 30%

Type of assessment: group

Evaluator: Supervisors, thread leaders

	Learning Outcome (numbers based on overall outcomes)	Criteria	4-5 Insufficient	6 Sufficient	7-8 Good	9-10 Excellent	Comments
Communicate	1.c. Write a research/grant proposal to clearly communicate a research plan, with background, knowledge gap, approach and impact section, including social implications.	Abstract	The abstract is not clear, or the abstract misses one or more key elements of the proposal	The abstract contains all key elements and can be understood but this requires some effort, or some key aspects are unclear	The abstract can be easily understood and clearly summarizes all key points	The abstract is a convincing and easy to read summary of the proposal, properly highlighting all its key elements	
		Key elements	Title, main question, method, and impact are not present or unclear, or the background/ knowledge gap section does not support the main question or is unclear	The main question/aim is clear but some aspects have not been introduced, and/or the title is unclear, and/or the proposed method and impact is not clearly described	The proposal title is clear, the main question and knowledge gap are clear and clearly introduced in the background section. Background section, method, and impact are all clearly described, but could have been more to the point or more convincing.	The proposal title, main question, background, method, and impact are fully and convincingly described. Attention is drawn to potential innovative aspects or valuable contributions of the research. Could form (part of) a true grant application.	
		Proposal structure, storyline, and argumentation	Paragraphs appear disconnected, and/or subheadings are missing or unclear, and/or use of figures/tables is incorrect or unclear, and/or claims are unsupported	Proposal is structured but the order of some items could have been more optimal; not all paragraphs have clear topics or some paragraphs appear disconnected, some subheadings are not informative (enough), use of some figures can be improved.	Very clearly structured with appropriate subheadings and pleasant overall layout. Paragraphs are well-connected and have clear topic. Figures are clear and consistent. Claims are well supported. Some minor aspects could still be improved.	The whole proposal is well structured. Storyline is clearly articulated. Figures are well integrated into the text. Claims are well supported, and choices are well argued for. Could form (part of) a true grant application	

				Occasionally, information is not well supported.			
		Language and style	Difficult to follow because of language/grammatical errors and poor style (language lacks conciseness and clarity).	Content is comprehensible but readability issues may occur. Grammar and spelling are sufficient; a few errors may occur.	Clear and precise academic style, concise and easily readable. Overall correct grammar and spelling.	Convincing, clear, and attractive language and style, easy to read. Clear grammar and spelling.	
		Social Impact	Lacks depth and overlooks social implications in research.	Proposal demonstrates some awareness of social implications but does not delve into them sufficiently.	Proposal provides insights into the social implications of the research.	Proposal demonstrates an understanding of the research's social implications and their significance.	
Collaborate	2.f. Provide constructive feedback and show openness to feedback from others. (to be filled by Thread Leader or Programme Director, not Supervisor)	Providing feedback to the other teams on their proposal based on the rubric	The feedback is not related to the content or the format of the proposal.	The feedback is brief, but it is based on the Proposal rubrics' elements related to communication and research.	The feedback is based on the Proposal rubrics' elements related to communication and research, it mentions positive and negative aspects of the proposal.	The detailed feedback is based on the Proposal rubrics' elements related to communication and research, and it is constructive, providing concrete feedback to make the other team's proposal better.	(to be filled by Thread Leader or Programme Director, not Supervisor)
Research	3.b. Formulate a research question and relevant research strategy to address it.	Research question formulation	The question is unclear, overly broad, or not addressing the research topic.	The question may require further refinement to effectively address the research topic.	The question is relevant to the research topic and demonstrates an understanding of the research area.	The question is highly specific, relevant, and shows a deep understanding of the research area.	
	3.d. Understand the dot on the horizon-- Identify interesting/solvable problems, long term possibility and	Long-term vision	Struggles with identifying problems, proposal lacks long-term vision	Proposal demonstrates a partial long-term vision but needs further development. Proposal identifies scientific challenges to some	Proposal demonstrates a clear long-term vision.	Proposal demonstrates a clear long-term vision, and scientific challenges are identified, contributing to a well-rounded perspective	

	challenges.			extent, but improvement is needed.			
	3.e. Create an overview of the different stakeholders that are involved in the research topic.	Stakeholders	Limited or unclear overview. Key stakeholders are missing or poorly defined.	Basic list of stakeholders, but incomplete or lacking clarity on relevance and roles.	Identifies most key stakeholders with reasonable clarity. Some insight into roles but may lack depth or structure.	Clear, complete, and well-structured overview of all relevant stakeholders. Shows understanding of their roles, interests and motivations.	
	3.f. Understand research grant application processes.	Research application process	Poor understanding. Unclear on structure, purpose, and process of grant applications.	Basic understanding of application parts. Limited awareness of funder expectations or strategic elements.	Good understanding of main components. Aware of funder fit and structure. Some gaps in detail or strategy.	Excellent grasp of full grant process. Understands funder expectations, structure, and strategy.	
Reflect	4.c. Ask for constructive feedback of supervisors.	Feedback	FAIL: Students have not or too late consulted the supervisor; suggestions are not taken into considerations.		PASS: Students have consulted the supervisor and/or peers to obtain feedback on the proposal; suggestions are taken into consideration.		